

REPORTING PER PUPIL COSTS

Annually, two calculations are prepared on the estimated average per pupil cost for public education. One to satisfy state requirements and another that is more commonly used in the region.

A. Calculations. Methodologies are described below:

1. State Calculation. The state calculation is prescribed and starts with all expenditures of the division, including Food Services and Capital Improvement Projects, then deducts specific grants and programs, capital outlay expenditures, and debt. This amount is then divided by the average daily membership to arrive at the cost per pupil amount.

2. General Calculation. The general calculation begins with total operating fund expenditures then deducts grants and specific programs that are not commonly included in the operating fund among local school divisions. This amount is then divided by K-12 enrollment to arrive at the cost per pupil amount.

B. Cost Per Pupil. Upon preparing the estimate of the amount of money deemed to be needed during the next fiscal year for the support of the schools, Chief Financial Officer will also prepare and distribute, within a reasonable time as prescribed by the Board of Education, notification of the estimated average per pupil cost for public education in the school division for the coming school year in accordance with the budget estimates provided to the appropriating body. The notification will also include actual per pupil state and local education expenditures for the previous school year. The notice may also include federal funds expended for public education in the school division.

C. Notice. The state calculation notice will be made available in a form provided by the Department of Education and shall be published on the school division's website or in hard copy upon request. The state calculation is also referenced in the Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR). The general calculation is published in LCPS Budget Documents and the Washington Area Boards of Education (WABE) Guide.

Adopted: 10/13/15

Revised: 2/9/21

Current Revision: 2/9/21

Confirmed: 8/1/24 (with technical changes)

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Legal Ref: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, § [22.1-92\(A\)](#)